

# Quarto Seminar Paper Template: How to Use

## First Steps

This document serves as a Quarto template for seminar papers, mainly aimed at university students. It is inspired by, but not compliant with, the APA style guide. If you have not previously installed a LaTeX distribution, which is needed to render the document to PDF, run the following two commands in your console of any R project:

```
install.packages("tinytex")  
  
tinytex::install_tinytex()
```

You may be prompted to confirm the continuation of the installation. If so, type “y” in the console and hit Enter.

## The Files

The template consists of the following files. Except for README.md and requirements.txt (which are not necessary for the template to work, and often not required of students), they must all be placed in the same project folder for the final document to render. In the next part, I briefly describe all files and give instructions on how you should use them, i.e., what you need to change for your project. The bullet points function as a to-do list for users of the template.

Bullet points highlighted in red *should not* be changed. The document may stop working.

Bullet points highlighted in blue *must* be changed.

Bullet points highlighted in green offer additional options, or tips.

### **main.Rproj**

This is the R-Project file.

- Rename this to match your project.

### **main.pdf**

The rendered PDF. Once you rename the main.qmd file, the name of the PDF will also change.

- Delete the old main.pdf file.

### **preamble.tex**

Contains LaTeX formatting, including the header, and text justification.

- Set the header title and author names.

### **apa.csl**

Ensures your in-text citation and bibliography style is automatically that of the APA style guide. This file must stay in the folder, but no changes need to be made to it.

### **references\_template.bib**

This contains your references.

- Create a folder in Zotero (or any other reference management software).
- Drag all articles and books you wish to cite into that folder.
- Right-click on the folder and export it as Better BibTeX.
- Replace references\_template.bib with your generated file.
- On line 40 in the main.qmd file, change the name of the bibliography file to your file.

### `exampleREADME.md` and `README.md`

A `README.md` file helps others understand your project contents and structure. Open `exampleREADME.md` with RStudio to see what it should approximately look like. Mention what files are included in your project folder, what they are for, what order they need to be run in, etc.

- Change `exampleREADME.md` to match your paper or delete it if not required for your project. Then delete “example” from the file name.
- The other file (`README.md`) can be deleted as well. I used it only to be displayed on GitHub.

### `requirements.txt`

Only for Python. A list of all libraries (packages) that other people need in order to run your Python files. It can be used to automatically install them into a virtual environment all at once.

- List your libraries or delete it if not required.

### `/data`

A folder containing your datasets.

- Place your data here. **Note:** Once you delete the data that is in the folder for the template, the code in the Quarto file will not work anymore.

### `/images`

A folder containing your images.

- Place your images here. **Note:** Once you delete the image that is in the folder for the template, the code in the Quarto file will not work anymore.

## main.qmd

The Quarto file that can be rendered to PDF. It is very likely that you will have other R or Python scripts (or additional Quarto files or Jupyter Notebooks) that clean data and recode variables. Place them in the folder alongside the files already listed here. Enumerate all files that contain code such that they can be run in succession without interruption. The image `project_folder.png` serves as an example of what a completed project folder should approximately look like.

- Rename `main.qmd` to match your project.
- Enumerate additional R or Python scripts/Quarto files/Jupyter Notebooks that contain code.
- If not needed anymore, delete the image `project_folder.png`.
- Set the paper title (line 3) and author name(s) (line 7).
- Write the seminar paper footnote, including instructor Email address (line 113).
- Write author footnote(s), including Email address and matriculation number (lines 115 and 117).
- If your paper is not in English, change the language (line 9) and date format (line 11).
- Change font and font size if necessary (lines 29 and 30).
- If you wish to use a citation style other than APA, link a different `.csl` file (line 41).
- Do not remove the code just before the appendix, it ensures appendix tables are labelled “A1” etc.
- Write the abstract. The placeholder is a template on how to write good abstracts by Prof. Fabrizio Gilardi (University of Zurich).
- “`header-includes`”: do not remove these lines in the YAML, otherwise the document will stop working.
  - Use `\blandscape` and `\elandscape` in the document to turn a page sideways. Particularly useful for regression tables with many models.
  - I set the line spacing to 1.5 (line 50). If necessary, change to `\singlespacing` or `\doublespacing`.
  - `\FloatBarrier` can be used in the document to stop tables and figures from floating past a certain point. However, `\floatplacement{table}{H}` turns off floating for this document. Remove this line, if you want floating, then use `\FloatBarrier` to restrict the movement of individual tables/figures if necessary.

- `\setlength{\parindent}{1.5em}` indents the first line of paragraphs (except the first one). If your document is in German, remove this line.

- **Other text formatting options:**

- `**To make text bold**`; `*for italics*`.
- Superscript `^2^` or Subscript `~2~`.
- If you need more space between a table/figure and the text use:  
`\vspace*{1cm}`.
- If you want to place something on a new page, use `\clearpage`.
- If you want to indent a certain part, i.e., the hypotheses use  
`\begin{adjustwidth}{1cm}{1cm}` and `\end{adjustwidth}`.

- **Citations**

- To see author keys, open your Zotero-generated references file (ends in .bib) with RStudio. Then:
  - Narrative citation: `@hereauthorkey`
    - with page: `@hereauthorkey [42]`
  - Parenthetical citation: `[@hereauthorkey]`
    - with page: `[@hereauthorkey, 42]`
  - More than one reference: `[@hereauthorkey; @hereauthorkey2]`
    - with page: `[@hereauthorkey, 42; @hereauthorkey2]`
  - For tables and figures, set the code chunk labels to include the `tbl-` or `fig-` prefix. Then, use `@tbl-yourtable` or `@fig-yourfigure` in the text to reference it.

- **Images and Links**

- Adding an image:  
`![Here your image caption](images/dag.pdf){#fig-dag width=12cm}`
- Adding a link:  
`[Link text you want to show](https://example.com)`
- Clickable linked images:  
`![Text](images/pic.png){width=12cm}](https://example.com)`

- **Footnotes**

- Use `[^youridentifer]` in the text then `[^youridentifer]`: at the bottom.

- **Endnotes**

- Use `\ref{note:yourlabelgoeshere}` for a note to appear in the notes section at the end, then add the text to the notes section.

- **Formulas**

- Use `$$ your formula here $$` to write LaTeX formulas.

Once you are done, delete the `.gitignore` and the Quarto Seminar Paper Template PDF files from your folder.